Postmates gets LA.

The business question is whether LA ~~users come back.~~

Postmates LA: Retention & Frequency Analysis

Synthetic data with self-designed schema

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THE SETUP

Postmates must own repeat, not just reach

BRAND ROLE

Independent challenger brand inside Uber Delivery.

Must prove distinct value, not just co-exist with Uber Eats.

S&O PROBLEM

Move from brand awareness to repeat behavior.

Translate 'in the know' positioning into measurable, habitual ordering.

LA OPPORTUNITY

LA's culture-driven, trend-sensitive audience is the ideal proving ground.

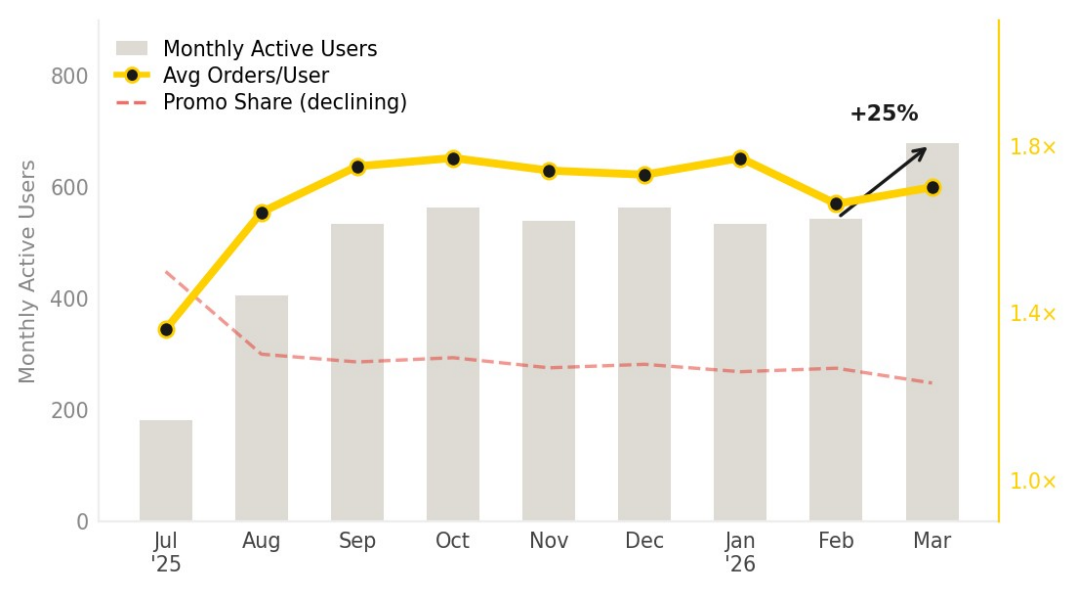
Local merchants + cultural relevance may create a repeat advantage.

Core question: Does Postmates' differentiated merchant mix actually drive higher repeat behavior in LA?

Analytical scope
cohort retention · segment behavior · merchant mix · promo dependency · delivery experience · social signal framework

EXECUTIVE SNAPSHOT

Growth is accelerating — but repeat quality is still the question



1.72×
avg orders / user (LA avg)

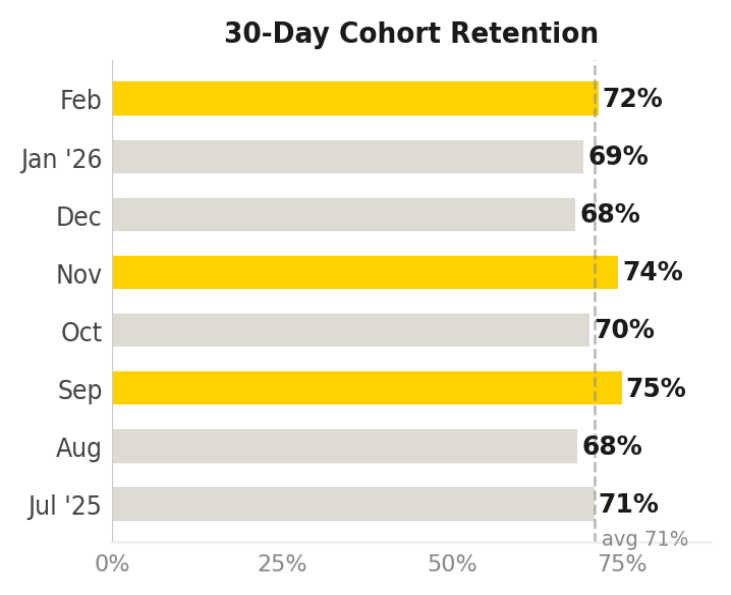
41%
promo order share (↓ declining)

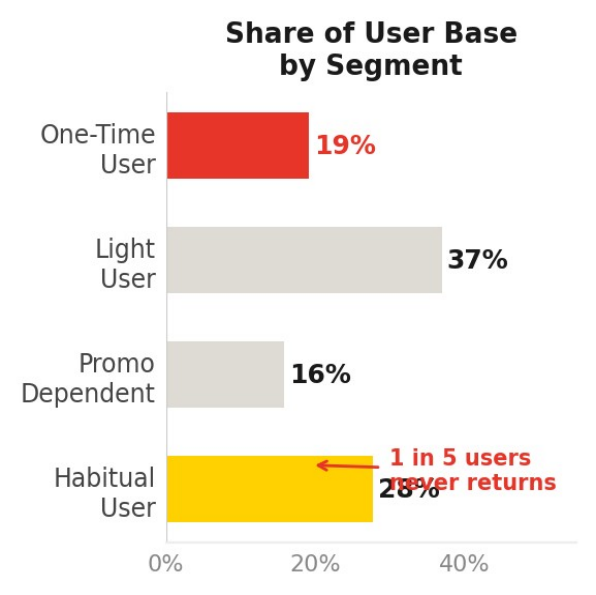
$23.1
avg order value

Topline growth is healthy, but at 41% promo mix, repeat quality deserves scrutiny. The next question is who comes back.

RETENTION DIAGNOSIS

The biggest opportunity: turning first orders into habits





OPPORTUNITY SIZING

one-time users

873

× 20% convert to 2nd

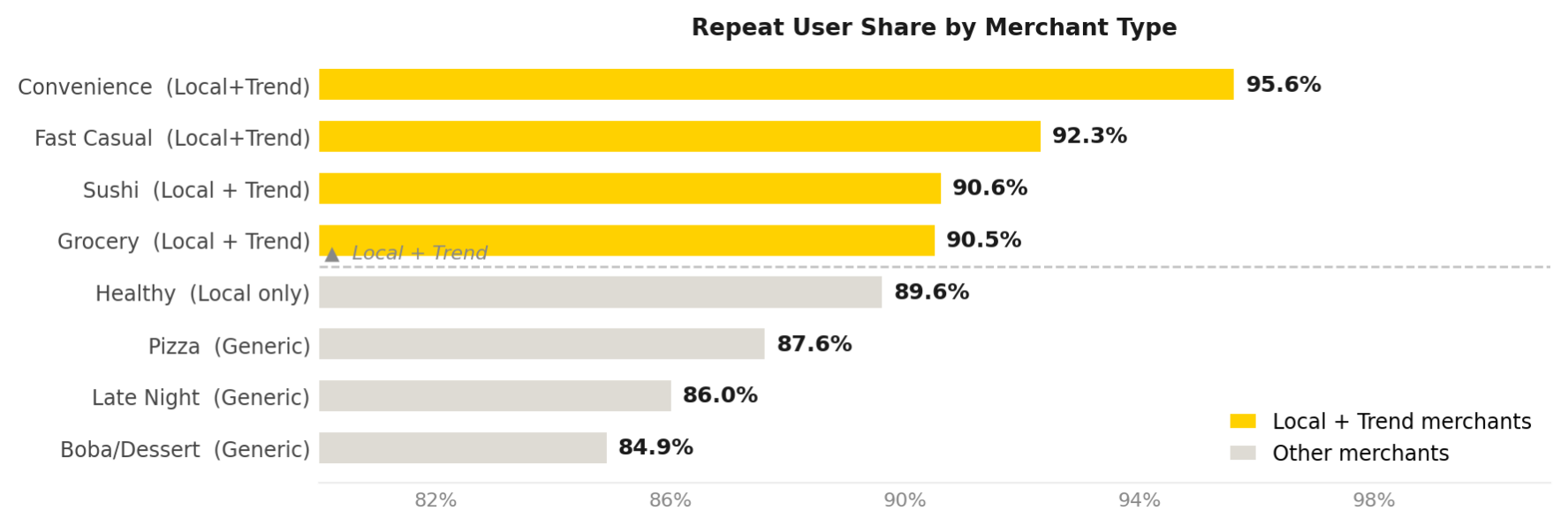
= 175 Incremental Orders

≈ $ 4.0K Incremental GMV

One-time users are the clearest retention leak in LA. Converting 20% of them to a second order would add ~175 orders and ~$4.0K GMV.

BRAND → BEHAVIOR

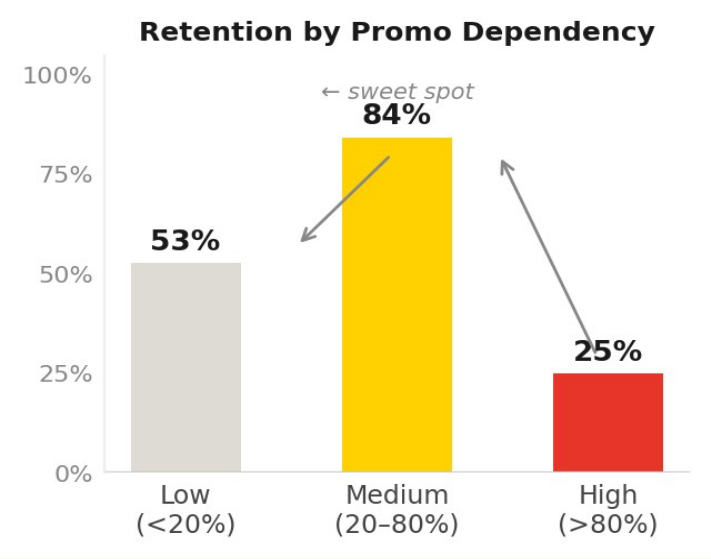
'In the Know' is measurable: local + trend merchants show the strongest repeat behavior

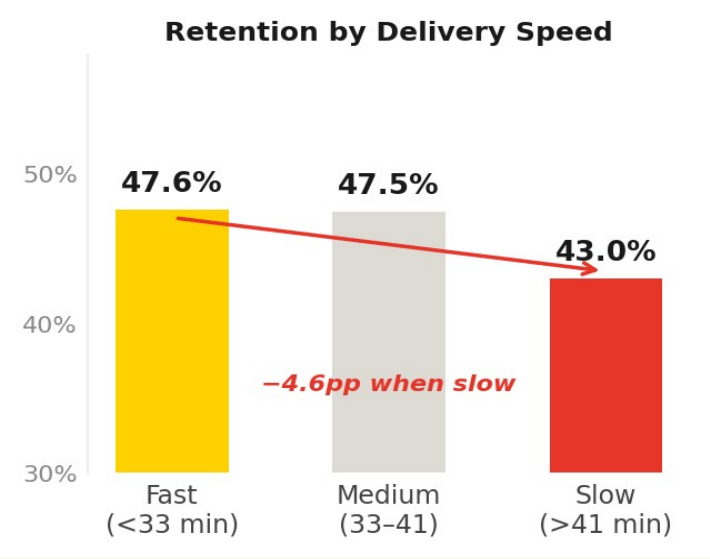


Postmates' "in the know" positioning shows behavioral proof: local + trend merchants lead the repeat chart. Curated supply looks like a key retention lever in LA.

RISKS + OPPORTUNITY

Two growth quality risks — and one realistic retention opportunity





SCENARIO

if 20% of one-time users convert to a 2nd order

+175
Incremental orders

= ~$ 4 K
incremental GMV

High promo dependency appears lower quality. The more durable upside is improving second-order conversion through discovery-led retention, not heavier discounting.

SOCIAL SIGNAL FRAMEWORK

Can social buzz act as an early demand signal for local merchant curation?

01 INPUT SIGNALS

- Social velocity
  - Creator + influencer buzz
  - Hashtag acceleration
  - Mention growth
- Local relevance
  - Event & pop-up spikes
  - Neighborhood buzz
- Merchant emergence
  - New openings
  - Trending merchants

Aggregated via dedicated social listening tools (Brandwatch, Sprout Social)

→

02 ANALYTICAL LAYER

- lead-lag analysis:
  Does buzz precede demand by 3–7 days?
- Signal scoring:
  Which signals predict repeat-friendly merchants?
- User overlap:
  Do retained users over-index on signal-led merchants?

S&O team builds the bridge between social data & order data

→

03 OPERATIONAL USE

- Operational use
  - Feature rising merchants in-app
  - Target CRM nudges before demand peaks
  - A/B test: signal-led curation vs. organic discovery cohort
- KPIs:
  - 2nd-order conversion rate
  - repeat rate
  - merchant GMV lift

Closes the loop: buzz → curation → retention

Hypothesis: If social buzz leads demand by 3–7 days, Postmates can feature merchants before they peak.
Business implication: That turns “in the know” from brand intuition into a measurable curation advantage.

From POSTMATE IT to POSTMATE IT AGAIN

Three bets, ranked by speed-to-signal

01

Second-Order Activation

WHAT TO TEST

A/B test: generic discount vs. local merchant rec vs. reorder nudge — triggered 48 hrs post-first-order.

KPI

2nd-order conversion rate
time-to-2nd-order

4 wks

02

Local Discovery Merchandising

WHAT TO TEST

Increase local + trend merchant exposure in first 30 days. Test discovery-oriented supply vs. control cohort.

KPI

30D repeat rate
local merchant order share

6 wks

03

Social Signal Scoring

WHAT TO TEST

Score merchant trend velocity using social buzz + creator data (Google Gemini / API). Target CRM nudges to rising merchants.

KPI

Signal-to-order lead time
cohort repeat rate

8 wks

HOW THIS WAS BUILT

How I built this case

01

Schema Design

Designed 4 linked SQL-compatible tables: users, merchants, orders, monthly metrics — mirroring real S&O data models with realistic distributions.

Custom synthetic data

02

SQL Analysis

Wrote retention queries: 30-day cohort analysis, segment-level repeat behavior, promo dependency, merchant mix breakdowns.

SQL · cohort / segment analysis

03

Python & visualization

Processed query outputs, built segment aggregations, generated Matplotlib charts styled for brand clarity and data legibility.

pandas · matplotlib · numpy

04

Strategic Narrative + AI Workflow

Translated analysis into an Uber-style business review narrative. Used AI to refine hypotheses, wording, and deck structure.

presentation · S&O storytelling

Skills:
SQL · Python (pandas, matplotlib) · Data modeling · Business storytelling · AI-assisted workflow design